

SOAP

Subject:

You might call it the topic, the main idea, the argument, the position, and, in writing circles, it is called the thesis. For now, let's keep it simple:

- *The SUBJECT is what you are writing (or reading) about.*

Occasion:

Every piece of writing, reading, or visual is located in time and place. It includes community, culture, geography, and history timeframe that prompts the piece of writing (or reading or visual).

- *The OCCASION, also called CONTEXT, is the circumstances surrounding what you are writing (or reading).*

Audience:

The audience for a piece of rhetoric is the person or group of people for whom you're writing. Although many people will encounter certain texts, every piece of writing (or reading) is designed with a certain audience in mind.

- *The AUDIENCE is the target of your writing.*

Purpose:

Every piece of rhetoric tries to accomplish something. You can state this purpose using an infinitive verb phrase, like "to entertain," "to persuade," "to explain."

- *The PURPOSE is why you are writing.*